

GradPilot AI — Total Build Plan

Product Vision, Feature Roadmap & What We Build Next

gradpilotai.com · Next.js on Vercel · Supabase · 20 June 2026

The opportunity in one line

We have a polished marketing site and a rich content backend — but **the actual “AI” product is not built yet**. Today GradPilot looks like a jobs board with guides. The vision is an **AI co-pilot that walks an international graduate all the way from “I need a visa-sponsoring job” to “I signed an offer”**: CV analysis, smart job matching, application tracking, interview prep, and a 24/7 adviser. That product layer is where the value, the retention, and the subscription revenue live. This plan lays out how we build it.

What exists today vs. what's missing

Built & live	Not built yet (the product)
Marketing site (landing, about, pricing, FAQ) Jobs board + job detail (30 roles) Blog / guides (10 posts) Mentors directory · Employer insights Email/password auth + protected dashboard shell Waitlist capture · SEO (sitemap, robots, OG) Hardened, seeded Supabase backend	AI CV analysis & scoring AI job matching (CV ↔ roles) Application tracker (kanban / status) AI interview prep (36 Qs sit unused) AI career adviser (chat) Stripe subscriptions (UI only, no payments) User profile / onboarding · saved jobs · alerts

Translation: the “shop window” is done; the “engine” is the build ahead.

1 · The five product pillars

Every feature ladders up to one of five pillars. This keeps the roadmap focused on the journey, not a pile of features.

1	Get Ready CV analysis & scoring, profile/onboarding, skills gap insights — get the candidate application-ready.
2	Find the Right Job AI job matching against the CV, visa-sponsor filtering, saved jobs, job alerts, employer insights.
3	Apply & Track One place to track every application: status kanban, deadlines, notes, document versions.
4	Ace the Interview AI mock interviews, the 36 seeded interview questions, company-specific prep, feedback.
5	Guidance & Community 24/7 AI career/visa adviser, mentors marketplace, guides, peer community.

2 · Full feature catalogue

Get Ready	Feature	Effort	Value
AI CV analysis & score	Upload CV → AI scores it, flags gaps, suggests fixes vs UK norms.	Med	HIGH
	Guided UK-style CV builder with export to PDF.	Med	MED
	Capture degree, field, visa status, target roles → personalises everything.	Small	HIGH
	Compare profile to target roles; recommend courses/certs.	Med	MED
Find the Job	Feature	Effort	Value
AI job matching	Rank the 30+ jobs by fit to the user's CV & preferences.	Med	HIGH
	Filter to roles that sponsor Skilled Worker / Graduate Route.	Small	HIGH
	Save roles; email/push alerts on new matches.	Small	MED
	Pull live sponsor-licence roles from external feeds/APIs.	Large	MED

Apply & Track	Feature	Effort	Value
Application tracker	Kanban: Saved → Applied → Interview → Offer; deadlines & notes.	Med	HIGH
	Store CV/cover-letter versions per application.	Small	MED
	Generate a tailored cover letter per job from the CV.	Med	HIGH
	Email/calendar reminders for closing dates & follow-ups.	Small	MED
Ace Interview	Feature	Effort	Value
AI mock interview	Chat/voice mock using the 36 seeded questions + role context.	Med	HIGH
	Pull employer insights into tailored prep packs.	Small	MED
	AI scores answers (STAR), suggests improvements.	Med	HIGH
Guidance	Feature	Effort	Value
AI career/visa adviser	24/7 chat grounded in our guides (RAG) — the headline feature.	Med	HIGH
	Book/pay mentors; calendar + video.	Large	MED
	Peer Q&A;, cohort channels.	Large	LOW
	Surface relevant blog guides by profile stage.	Small	MED

Effort: Small = ½–2 days · Med = 3–7 days · Large = 2+ weeks. Value = expected impact on activation, retention & conversion.

3 · Phased build roadmap

Phase	Theme	What we ship	Why
0 Now	Launch-ready	Stripe checkout · leaked-password protection · auth-flow verify · analytics · go public.	Turn the live shell into a sellable, measurable product.
1 MVP	The AI core	Onboarding wizard · AI CV analysis · AI job matching · saved jobs · real dashboard.	Deliver the “AI co-pilot” promise; first real reason to sign up & stay.
2 V1	Convert & retain	Application tracker · AI cover letters · AI adviser (RAG) · job alerts.	Daily-use habit loop + the features people will pay for.
3 V2	Win interviews	AI mock interviews + feedback · company-specific prep · CV builder.	Complete the journey to “offer”; strong word-of-mouth.
4 Scale	Growth & moat	Auto-import live sponsor jobs · mentor booking+pay · community · mobile/PWA.	Defensibility, supply of jobs, and network effects.

4 · My recommendation — what to build first

If I were driving this, the order is deliberate: **get paid + measurable first, then ship the one feature that defines the brand.**

- **Finish Phase 0 this week** (Stripe + password protection + analytics + go public). Without payments and analytics we're flying blind and leaving money on the table. I can start these now.
- **Build AI CV analysis as the flagship MVP feature.** It's the most “wow”, it's self-contained, and it's the natural first step of every user's journey. It instantly makes GradPilot feel like AI, not a job board.
- **Pair it with AI job matching.** Once we've parsed the CV, matching it to our 30 roles is cheap and turns the jobs board into a personalised feed — huge perceived value for low effort.
- **Then the AI adviser (RAG over our guides).** We already have 10 guides + 26 employer insights — grounding a chatbot in them is fast and gives a defensible, on-brand 24/7 helper.
- **Application tracker for retention.** This is what brings people back daily and justifies a subscription.

Technical foundations these unlock (build once, reuse everywhere)

- **AI layer:** Claude API (Anthropic) for CV analysis, matching, cover letters, adviser & interview feedback — one integration powers most features.
- **File storage:** Supabase Storage for CV/document uploads + a parsing pipeline (PDF/DOCX → text).
- **Vector search (RAG):** Supabase pgvector to ground the adviser in our guides & insights.
- **Billing:** Stripe Checkout + webhooks → gate premium features by plan.
- **Background jobs:** for job alerts, reminders, and auto-import (cron / queue).
- **Email:** transactional (Resend/Supabase) for alerts, reminders, onboarding.

5 · What else we can do (differentiators & moonshots)

Idea	What it is	Why it's interesting
Visa eligibility checker	Interactive tool: answer a few questions → which UK visa routes fit you.	High-intent SEO magnet; unique to our niche; great lead capture.
Salary & sponsor explorer	Data tool: salary ranges + which employers hold sponsor licences by sector.	Builds on employer insights; sticky, shareable, ranks on Google.
Browser extension	"Does this employer sponsor?" badge on LinkedIn/Indeed job posts.	Meets users where they job-hunt; viral distribution.
WhatsApp / email AI adviser	Same adviser, delivered via WhatsApp where this audience lives.	Massive for international students; low-friction engagement.
Employer / B2B side	Let sponsoring employers post roles & reach vetted candidates.	A second revenue line; closes the marketplace loop.
University partnerships	White-label careers tool for uni international offices.	B2B2C distribution; credibility & volume.
Success tracking / outcomes	Track offers landed; publish anonymised success stats.	Powerful social proof & marketing flywheel.

Monetisation paths

- **Freemium subscription** (primary): free CV score + browsing; Pro unlocks full analysis, unlimited matching, AI adviser, cover letters, mock interviews. (Pricing UI already exists.)
- **Mentor marketplace take-rate**: commission on paid mentor bookings.
- **B2B employer postings** and **university partnerships** as later, higher-value lines.
- **Affiliate** on relevant services (visa/legal, courses, banking) where genuinely useful.

My bottom line: the foundation is done — now we build the engine. Ship **Phase 0 (launch-ready)** this week, then make **AI CV analysis + AI job matching** the flagship MVP, followed by the **AI adviser** and **application tracker**. That sequence turns GradPilot from a content site into a genuine AI co-pilot people pay for. Tell me which one to start and I'll begin building.